



trailing behind her, and tried carrying weights on her head to get used to the heavy crown she would have to wear.

The day, when at last it arrived, was wet. Along the procession route thousands of people had sat all night under blankets to ensure they had a good view. Elizabeth wore a white satin gown, and rode in the Gold State Coach drawn by eight horses. Inside Westminster Abbey, she went through the three-hour ceremony without a stumble. She remembered that Queen Victoria had done this too, when Victoria was only 18. Serious and calm, the new Queen sat upright on the ancient oak coronation chair.



Elizabeth rode in style, but the historic gold coach gave a very bumpy ride!